ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE N

Vote YES on Measure N for Safer, Better Local Schools, Without Raising Taxes!

Some of our schools were built so long ago that underground pipes and infrastructure are failing, resulting in gas leaks, water leaks, and sewage backups. Last year alone there were 380 roof leaks.

While our schools are well cared for, many were built more than 60 years ago and don't meet modern building safety codes. Local students and teachers rely on more than 400 portable classrooms that are over 25 years old and falling apart. We need to replace decaying portables with modern, permanent classrooms.

Some buildings aren't accessible for students with disabilities, and others have hazardous materials such as asbestos and lead pipes.

Updating our schools now will set up our students for college and career success. Not only will Measure N improve and upgrade our local schools, but it will do it **without raising taxes.**

Vote YES on N for Safer, Better Local Schools:

- Remove hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes, including from school sites that are over 50 years old
- Fix deteriorating, roofs, plumbing, gas, sewer, and electrical systems to reduce maintenance costs
- Upgrade older schools so they meet current health codes, building safety codes, and provide proper access for students with disabilities
- Provide modern labs, technology and career technology so students are prepared in science and math for college and careers

Measure N requires a transparent system of accountability:

- All money would stay in Vista Unified schools and can't be taken away by the State
- A detailed project list outlining how funds are spent
- An independent citizens' oversight committee and annual audits
- **Will not raise taxes**

Join local parents, teachers, and community leaders in voting YES on N for our neighborhood schools, without raising taxes!

MICHAEL FOWLKES
President, Vista Unified Council of PTAs (VUCPTA)

MARK KERSEY
President & CEO, San Diego Taxpayers Association

SEAN KEONI ELLIS
Master Instructor and Fmr. Veterans Lead and Pipe Fitting Instructor/Supervisor, United Association of Plumbers and Pipefitters

RACHEL BELD
President & CEO, Vista Chamber of Commerce

CAROL KIM
Business Manager, San Diego County Building & Construction Trades Council

REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE N

Vote NO on N

Measure N supporters claim it will not raise taxes. This is **MISLEADING**. It will extend current taxes, which expire in 2028, until 2063! ***Measure N will take more money from you for 35 years.***

Measure N supporters use routine maintenance, repairs, lead and asbestos abatement to justify this money grab. All buildings require maintenance and repairs. Failure to set aside reserves for ***these certain costs highlights the Board's incompetence***. Asbestos and lead have been known hazards for 50 years, yet they've done nothing. Why would you believe they will act now?

In 2018, Bond Measure LL was approved for $247 million using similar justifications. Now they want $543 million! ***Don't reward their mismanagement with more money.***

Measure N supporters say it is "for our students". These "for the children" type statements are ***ploys to emotionally manipulate voters*** and avoid objective evaluation of the proposal. Stirring emotions to avoid calm, rationality is a known propaganda technique. Don't fall for it.

Measure N supporters claim "A Citizen's Oversight Committee" will be formed to ensure money is properly spent. How frequently do we hear of "oversight committees" yet government waste continues unabated? These Committee members will be appointed by the Vista School District Board itself, so in effect, **the proposed "oversight" will be performed by the Board's buddies.**

Keep money in your pocket and Vote NO on N.

SANDRA LEVEE
Concerned Citizen

COLETTE KELLEY
Accountant

ADRIANNE SILVERIA
Concerned Citizen

JAMES SILVERIA
Teamsters Commercial Truck Driver

RAFAEL MARTINEZ
Engineer

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE N

Measure N is a $543 million bond proposed by the Vista Unified School District (VUSD). In 2018 voters approved Measure LL a 30 year VUSD bond totaling $247 million. The stated purpose of the bond was "to repair, upgrade, equip classrooms, science labs, local school facilities supporting college readiness, career preparation, math, science, engineering, technology, skilled trades; repair aging classrooms/schools including deteriorating roofs, plumbing and electrical; improve student safety/school security". That is essentially the same language and purpose for the currently proposed Measure N, a 35 year bond. This is an example of government inefficiency in spending and operations.

Measure N states it will not likely raise property taxes nevertheless it is estimated to cost $58 per $100,000 of home value. The average Vista home is valued at $870,000. This costs $505 per year in property taxes each year. Over the bond's 35 year lifetime that is over $17,000 paid by you as a property owner or renter. Had you invested that $505 annually at 5% over 35 years you would have accumulated almost $46,000 of your own money. Measure N add a significant financial burden to you, your family and your future. Government has an insatiable appetite for your tax dollars that is never satisfied.
Please VOTE NO on Measure N.

SANDRA LEVEE

COLETTE KELLEY

ADRIANNE SILVERIA

JAMES R. SILVERIA

RAFAEL MARTINEZ

REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE N

Voters approved Measure LL a decade ago, and projects were done on time, on budget and as promised. Independent citizen oversight and public audits verified this.

Sound management of past bonds is why VUSD gets high marks from the San Diego County Taxpayers Association - and why they endorse Measure N now. This includes paying off a previous bond early, decreasing the cost to taxpayers.

While much has been accomplished, much work remains.

FACT: Our aging schools need critical repairs. Some schools were built decades ago, and underground pipes and infrastructure are failing. Last year, there were **380 roof leaks**. Measure N will fix these problems.

FACT: Investment in schools protects property values. Numerous studies show that well-funded schools maintain demand for nearby homes and increase property values.

FACT: Students and teachers deserve better than 25-year-old portable classrooms. Measure N will replace deteriorating portables with permanent classrooms.

FACT: Measure N is not a tax increase. It provides funding to repair and improve local schools while keeping the property tax rate at its current level.

FACT: Many schools are over 60 years old and need safety and accessibility upgrades. Some buildings don't meet modern health and safety standards or provide adequate accessibility for students with disabilities.

FACT: Measure N requires strong accountability. An independent citizens' oversight committee, a detailed project list, and public disclosure of spending ensure transparency.

Visit www.BetterSaferVistaUSDSchools.org to learn more, volunteer, endorse, or donate!

Our Community Agrees — Vote YES on N for Great Neighborhood Schools. No Tax Increase.

LISA DE JESUS
Realtor & School Oversight Volunteer

MICHAEL SALDAÑA
President, Vista Fire Fighters Association

ROBERTO RODRIGUEZ
Trustee, Palomar College Governing Board

KRISTIN CHILDS
Special Educator

VINCE HINOJOSA
Financial Planner, Education Volunteer & Retired Marine